

Windows did not support Bluetooth until Windows XP Service Pack 2 – all later versions have Bluetooth support and native drivers. Apple has supported Bluetooth since Mac OS X v.10.2 which was released in 2002.

Linux has two popular Bluetooth stacks, BlueZ and Affix. BlueZ was developed by Qualcomm and Affix by Nokia.

Now, many companies provide Bluetooth dongles. Microsoft also has its own hardware. We recommend you go to the closest electronics shop and enquire what is readily available. A good range is necessary. Hence choose your Bluetooth hardware according to your requirement. You should consider a few factors such as the size of your house, the possibility of interference, etc. We have also mentioned a few profiles earlier on, so based on why you need Bluetooth, you should ensure that the hardware supports all profiles. Most do.

What you need:

- Desktop PC with Windows XP Service Pack 2 installed.
- A Bluetooth dongle (usually in the form of a USB stick).
- Driver installation file – check out native support in case of laptop drivers. There are several internet locations for downloading Widcomm/Broadcom drivers.
- BFor specific software purposes, download the required software – we shall not be dealing with this as it might vary from user to user. e.g. the Nokia PC Suite for specific Nokia support for Bluetooth.

Basic preparation

- Log on to Windows with administrative rights.
- Ensure your firewall is turned off .
- Disable antivirus if required.

Insert the Bluetooth device into the USB Slot. If your computer detects it automatically, you are lucky. In that case, you need not bother installing the driver as it is pre-installed.

If it does not detect it, you do not yet have Bluetooth support, so install the drivers. But before installing the driver, ensure that the Bluetooth device is not plugged into the USB port. Also ensure that all earlier software which is similar is uninstalled. Installers usually take care of this feature.

Extract the required files and install them. All installers